

CHAPTER 2

# Nationalism in India

NCERT Exercise Solutions


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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.

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## Activity · The Idea of Satyagraha

**Read Source A carefully. What did Mahatma Gandhi mean when he said satyagraha is active resistance?**

✔ ANSWER

Gandhiji meant that satyagraha is **not** a 'weapon of the weak' or a quiet, passive way of accepting injustice.

- It calls for **intense activity**: the satyagrahi openly and actively opposes an unjust law or ruler.
- But the fight is with **soul-force** (truth and non-violence), not physical force or arms.
- A satyagrahi does not hurt the opponent or seek his destruction; there is no ill-will.
- He wins by appealing to the **conscience** of the oppressor and persuading him to see the truth.
- So it needs great courage and self-control; Gandhiji said it can be used only by the strong.

## Activity · The Movement in the Towns

**The year is 1921. You are a student in a government-controlled school. Design a poster urging school students to answer**

Gandhiji's call to join the Non-Cooperation Movement.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**Model poster (draw it with a picture of a charkha / a bonfire of foreign cloth and the Swaraj flag):**

**STUDENTS OF INDIA – ANSWER THE MAHATMA'S CALL!**

- Leave government-controlled schools and colleges – do not cooperate with British rule.
- British rule survives only because Indians cooperate. If we refuse, swaraj will come!
- Boycott foreign cloth – wear khadi, spin on the charkha.
- Join national schools and colleges set up by Indians.
- Stay peaceful: non-violence is our strength.

**Non-Cooperation today – Swaraj tomorrow! Vande Mataram!**

## ✏️ Activity · Rebellion in the Countryside

? **If you were a peasant in Uttar Pradesh in 1920, how would you have responded to Gandhiji's call for Swaraj? Give reasons for your response.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**Model answer:** As a peasant of Awadh (UP) in 1920, I would have joined the movement eagerly.

- Talukdars and landlords demanded very high rents and many other cesses.
- We had to do **begar** (unpaid labour) on the landlords' farms.
- We had no security of tenure and were often evicted from the land.
- Swaraj, for me, would mean lower revenue/rent, an end to begar and freedom from oppressive landlords.
- I would join the Oudh Kisan Sabha (Jawaharlal Nehru, Baba Ramchandra) and take part in nai–dhobi bandhs and the social boycott of oppressive landlords, peacefully, as Gandhiji asked.

## 🧪 Activity · Swaraj in the Plantations

**? Find out about other participants in the National Movement who were captured and put to death by the British. Can you think of a similar example from the national movement in Indo-China?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**India – some participants executed by the British:**

- **Alluri Sitaram Raju** (leader of the Gudem rebels) – captured and executed in 1924 (from this chapter).
- **Bhagat Singh**, with **Sukhdev** and **Rajguru** – hanged in 1931 (Bhagat Singh was 23).
- **Ram Prasad Bismil** and **Ashfaqulla Khan** (Kakori case) – hanged in 1927.
- **Khudiram Bose** – hanged in 1908.

**Indo-China (Vietnam): Nguyen Thai Hoc**, leader of the Vietnamese Nationalist Party, was executed by the French in 1930 after the Yen Bai uprising. Like Raju and Bhagat Singh, he chose armed struggle and became a national hero.

## 💬 Discuss · The Civil Disobedience Movement

**? Why did various classes and groups of Indians participate in the Civil Disobedience Movement?**

✔ ANSWER

Each group joined with its own hopes; swaraj meant different things to each.

- **Rich peasants** (Patidars of Gujarat, Jats of UP): hit by the depression and falling prices, they could not pay revenue; for them swaraj was a fight against high revenue.
- **Poor peasants / small tenants**: could not pay rent; they wanted unpaid rent to the landlord to be remitted.

- **Business classes** (Purshottamdas Thakurdas, G. D. Birla, FICCI): wanted protection against foreign imports and a rupee-sterling ratio that discouraged imports; swaraj meant an end to colonial restrictions on business.
- **Industrial workers** (some, e.g. Nagpur region, railway workers, dockworkers, Chotanagpur tin miners): used boycott of foreign goods in their own fight against low wages and poor working conditions.
- **Women**: moved by Gandhiji's call, they saw service to the nation as a sacred duty; they marched, made salt and picketed shops.

So all were united by anger against colonial rule, though their aims were different.

### 💬 Discuss · The Limits of Civil Disobedience (Source D)

**? Read Source D carefully. Do you agree with Iqbal's idea of communalism? Can you define communalism in a different way?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**Iqbal's idea:** each community (group) has the right to free development on the lines of its own culture and tradition; this 'higher' communalism, with separate electorates, is a safeguard for minorities and is needed for a harmonious India.

**Model view:** I agree partly. Protecting the culture and rights of minorities is fair and important. But dividing politics by religion and separate electorates can keep communities apart and weaken national unity (it later gave the intellectual base for the Pakistan demand).

**Another definition:** Communalism is the belief that people of one religion form one community with common interests that are different from, and opposed to, those of other religious communities. It leads to using religion in politics, suspicion and even riots between communities.

Rights of minorities can be protected through equal citizenship, fundamental rights and a secular constitution instead.

## 🧪 Activity · The Sense of Collective Belonging

**? Look at Figs. 12 and 14. Do you think these images will appeal to all castes and communities? Explain your views briefly.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

No, they may not appeal to all castes and communities.

- Bharat Mata is shown as a **Hindu goddess**: an ascetic with a mala (Fig. 12), or with a trishul, a lion and an elephant (Fig. 14).
- These images are drawn from **Hindu iconography**.

- People of other religions (Muslims, Christians and others) could feel left out, as the chapter says.
- Many lower castes too might not relate to these upper-caste religious symbols.

So such images united many Hindus but could not unite all Indians equally.

## ⭐ Write in brief

**1 (a)** **Explain why growth of nationalism in the colonies is linked to an anti-colonial movement.**

✔ ANSWER

- In colonies like India, people began discovering their **unity** in the struggle against colonialism.
- The sense of being **oppressed** under colonial rule gave a shared bond that tied many different groups together.
- Each group suffered from colonialism in its own way, but all wanted freedom from it.
- Leaders like Mahatma Gandhi and the Congress brought these groups together in one movement.

So the feeling of being one nation grew through the anti-colonial struggle.

**1 (b)** **Explain how the First World War helped in the growth of the National Movement in India.**

✔ ANSWER

The war created a new economic and political situation:

- Huge **defence expenditure** was met by war loans and higher taxes: customs duties were raised and **income tax** introduced.
- **Prices doubled** between 1913 and 1918, causing great hardship to common people.
- **Forced recruitment** of soldiers in villages caused widespread anger.
- Crops failed in 1918–19 and 1920–21, causing food shortages; with an **influenza epidemic**, 12 to 13 million people died (census of 1921).
- People hoped hardships would end after the war, but they did not.

This anger made people ready to join a mass movement under Gandhiji's new method of satyagraha.

**1 (c)** **Explain why Indians were outraged by the Rowlatt Act.**

✔ ANSWER

- The Rowlatt Act (1919) was **hurriedly passed** by the Imperial Legislative Council despite the **united opposition of the Indian members**.

- It gave the government **enormous powers to repress** political activities.
- It allowed **detention of political prisoners without trial for two years**.

Indians saw it as an unjust law that took away their basic rights, so Gandhiji started a nationwide satyagraha against it (hartal on 6 April 1919).

**1 (d) Explain why Gandhiji decided to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement.**

✔ ANSWER

- In February 1922 Gandhiji withdrew the movement because it was **turning violent** in many places.
- At **Chauri Chaura** (Gorakhpur), a peaceful demonstration turned into a violent clash with the police.
- He felt that **satyagrahis needed proper training** before they were ready for mass struggles.
- Non-violence was the basis of his struggle, so he would not allow violence in its name.

**2 What is meant by the idea of satyagraha?**

✔ ANSWER

Satyagraha was Mahatma Gandhi's method of mass agitation, based on **truth and non-violence**.

- It stressed the power of truth and the need to search for truth.
- If the cause was true and the struggle was against injustice, **physical force was not necessary** to fight the oppressor.
- Without seeking vengeance or being aggressive, a satyagrahi could win through **non-violence**.
- This was done by appealing to the **conscience of the oppressor**; people, including oppressors, were persuaded to see the truth, not forced by violence.
- Truth was bound to triumph in the end. Gandhiji believed this dharma of non-violence could unite all Indians.

**3 (a)** **Write a newspaper report on: The Jallianwala Bagh massacre.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

**HUNDREDS KILLED IN AMRITSAR FIRING**

*Amritsar, 14 April 1919 (Our Correspondent)*

Yesterday, 13 April, on the day of the Baisakhi fair, a large crowd gathered in the enclosed ground of **Jallianwala Bagh**. Some had come to protest against the government's new repressive measures (the Rowlatt Act and the arrest of local leaders); others had come for the fair. Many villagers from outside the city did not know that **martial law** had been imposed.

**General Dyer** entered the ground with troops, **blocked the exit points** and **opened fire** on the unarmed crowd without warning. **Hundreds were killed** and many more wounded.

General Dyer later said his object was to 'produce a moral effect' – to create terror and awe in the minds of satyagrahis.

As the news spreads, crowds are taking to the streets in many north Indian towns, with strikes and clashes with the police. The whole country is in shock and anger.

**3 (b)** **Write a newspaper report on: The Simon Commission.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**'GO BACK SIMON' – INDIA PROTESTS AN ALL-WHITE COMMISSION**

*Bombay, 1928 (Our Correspondent)*

The Statutory Commission headed by **Sir John Simon**, set up by the new Tory government in Britain, arrived in India today. It is to look into the working of the constitutional system in India and suggest changes.

But the commission **does not have a single Indian member** – all its members are British. Indians see this as an insult.

It was greeted with black flags and the slogan **'Go back Simon'**. All parties, including the **Congress and the Muslim League**, joined the demonstrations.

During a peaceful demonstration against the commission, **Lala Lajpat Rai** was assaulted by the British police; he later died of his injuries.

The protests show that Indians will no longer accept decisions about their future made without them.

**4** **Compare the images of Bharat Mata in this chapter with the image of Germania in Chapter 1.**

✔ ANSWER

Both are **female figures** (allegories) used to show the nation, so that people could identify with it.

| Bharat Mata (India) | Germania (Germany) |
|---|---|
| Abanindranath Tagore's painting (1905) shows her as an ascetic: calm, composed, divine and spiritual | Philip Veit's painting (1848) shows her as a strong, heroic figure |
| Dispenses learning, food and clothing; holds a mala (ascetic quality) | Wears a crown of oak leaves (heroism), holds a sword (readiness to fight) |
| Another image (Fig. 14) shows her with a trishul, a lion and an elephant: symbols of power and authority | Broken chains (freedom), breastplate with eagle (strength), olive branch (willingness to make peace), black-red-gold flag |

| | |
|---|---|
| Drawn from Hindu religious iconography, so some communities felt left out | Shown as a secular warrior symbol of German unity and liberalism |

Bharat Mata is mostly a **mother goddess** figure linked to devotion and sacrifice, while Germania is a **warrior** figure linked to power and freedom.

## Discuss

**1** **List all the different social groups which joined the Non-Cooperation Movement of 1921. Then choose any three and write about their hopes and struggles to show why they joined the movement.**

✔ ANSWER

**Groups that joined:** middle-class people in towns (students, teachers, headmasters, lawyers), merchants and traders, peasants (e.g. in Awadh), tribal people (e.g. Gudem Hills, Andhra Pradesh), plantation workers (Assam), and Muslims (through the Khilafat issue).

**1. Peasants of Awadh:** Led by Baba Ramchandra, they fought talukdars and landlords who demanded very high rents and cesses and forced them to do begar. They wanted reduction of revenue, abolition of begar and social boycott of oppressive landlords (nai–dhobi bandhs). The Oudh Kisan Sabha (Oct 1920) had over 300 branches.

**2. Tribals of the Gudem Hills:** The government closed forests, so they could not graze cattle or collect fuelwood and fruits, and forced them to do begar for road building. Led by Alluri Sitaram Raju, they saw swaraj as getting back their traditional rights; they used guerrilla warfare.

**3. Plantation workers of Assam:** Under the Inland Emigration Act of 1859 they could not leave the tea gardens without permission. For them swaraj meant the right to move freely and keep a link with their villages; thousands left the plantations, believing Gandhi Raj was coming and they would get land.

(Also possible: **middle class** – students left government schools, lawyers gave up practice, foreign cloth was burnt; **Muslims** – to defend the Khalifa's powers.)

**2** **Discuss the Salt March to make clear why it was an effective symbol of resistance against colonialism.**

✔ ANSWER

Gandhiji found in salt a powerful symbol that could **unite the whole nation**.

- Salt was used by **the rich and the poor alike**; it was one of the most essential items of food.

- The **tax on salt** and the government's **monopoly over its production** showed the most oppressive face of British rule.
- On 31 January 1930, Gandhiji sent Viceroy Irwin **eleven demands**, the most stirring being the abolition of the salt tax; Irwin refused to negotiate.
- Gandhiji walked over **240 miles** from **Sabarmati to Dandi** with **78 volunteers** in 24 days; thousands came to hear him.
- On **6 April 1930** he broke the salt law by making salt from sea water; this began the **Civil Disobedience Movement**.
- Thousands across India broke the salt law, boycotted foreign cloth and picketed liquor shops.

So a simple, everyday item turned the abstract idea of freedom into a concrete issue that everyone could join.

**3** **Imagine you are a woman participating in the Civil Disobedience Movement. Explain what the experience meant to your life.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**Model answer:**

- Before the movement my life was limited to my home and family.
- When Gandhiji passed near our village during the salt march, I came out with thousands of women to listen to him.

- For the first time I stepped into public life: I joined protest marches, made salt and picketed foreign cloth and liquor shops.
- Some of us were beaten and many went to jail, but we felt proud.
- I began to see **service to the nation as a sacred duty** of women.
- It gave me confidence and a new identity as a citizen fighting for freedom.
- Yet I also saw that the Congress gave women few positions of authority; our larger role in society still had to be won.

**4** **Why did political leaders differ sharply over the question of separate electorates?**

✔ ANSWER

Leaders differed because they had different ideas about how to protect minorities and keep the nation united.

- **Dalit leaders** like **Dr B.R. Ambedkar** demanded separate electorates for dalits; they believed **political empowerment** would end their social disabilities.
- **Gandhiji** opposed this and began a **fast unto death**: he felt separate electorates would slow down dalits' integration into society. The result was the **Poona Pact** (Sept 1932): reserved seats, but voted by the general electorate.

- Many **Muslim leaders** (e.g. **Muhammad Iqbal**, 1930) saw separate electorates as a safeguard for Muslims as a minority; they feared their culture would be submerged under a Hindu majority.
- **Jinnah** was ready to give up separate electorates if Muslims got reserved seats in the Central Assembly and representation in proportion to population in Bengal and Punjab.
- **Hindu Mahasabha** leaders like **M.R. Jayakar** strongly opposed compromise (All Parties Conference, 1928).
- The **Congress** feared that separate electorates would divide Indians and weaken the united struggle.

So the issue was about representation and power in future assemblies, and it caused deep distrust between communities.

## 🛠️ Project

**? Find out about the anti-colonial movement in Indo-China. Compare and contrast India's national movement with the ways in which Indo-China became independent.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

**Model project plan:**

- **Collect information:** French colonial rule in Vietnam; nationalist leaders (Phan Boi Chau, Phan Chu Trinh, Ho Chi Minh); the Communist Party (1930); the Vietminh; independence declared in 1945; war with France, Dien Bien Phu (1954); the war with the USA and reunification (1975).

**Compare (similarities):**

- Both grew out of anger against colonial exploitation and taxes.
- In both, peasants, students and workers took part, and religion and culture were used to unite people.

**Contrast (differences):**

| India | Indo-China (Vietnam) |
|---|---|
| Mostly non-violent mass movements (satyagraha) under Gandhiji and the Congress | Mostly armed struggle and guerrilla war, led by Communists under Ho Chi Minh |
| Independence through negotiation and transfer of power in 1947 | Independence through long wars, against France and later the USA |
| Country became a democratic republic | Country became a communist state |

- **Present it** as a chart or booklet with a timeline, pictures and a conclusion.

🎉 **Chapter 2 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**